

examine your baby's chromosomes and identify whether your baby has a chromosomal abnormality such as Down syndrome.

Sometimes, for very specific reasons, the amniotic fluid is tested for the presence of toxoplasmosis or cytomegalovirus.



In a diagnostic test, the doctor uses ultrasound to guide a fine needle into the abdomen to take a sample of amniotic fluid (amniocentesis) or tissue from the placenta (chorionic villus sampling).

How you might feel

You may be concerned about having a procedure during pregnancy, but the majority of women find it is not particularly painful. In a transabdominal procedure, the needle usually doesn't hurt any more than a blood test. Sometimes the doctor will give a small amount of local anesthetic before the transabdominal procedure to numb the area —